Red woollen cloth, a popular material for waistcoats

Brass or other yellow metal buttons

Drop fly

Belt
The sailor usually wore a simple wide black leather belt with a brass buckle.

Trousers
As a rule, trousers were loose-fitting for ease of movement. White duck, a hard-wearing cotton weave, was a favourite material, but trousers could be of any colour or pattern – many were striped.

Buckle and strap fastening

Buckled shoes
Much of the time they were on board ship, sailors went barefoot, but would put on their best pair of shoes for the Captain's inspection and church service on Sunday.

Tough hardwood handle

Boarding axe
The boarding axe was used to cut stays, cables, and rigging when boarding an enemy ship. It also came in handy as an offensive weapon in hand-to-hand fighting.

Single-edged blade tapered to a stabbing point

> "SOME WERE STRIPPED TO THE WAIST; SOME HAD BARED THEIR NECKS AND ARMS; OTHERS HAD TIED A HANDKERCHIEF ROUND THEIR HEADS; AND ALL SEEMED EAGERLY TO AWAIT THE ORDER TO ENGAGE."
>
> 16-YEAR-OLD **PAUL HARRIS NICHOLAS**, ROYAL MARINES, DESCRIBING SAILORS ON HMS *BELLEISLE* AT TRAFALGAR

Boarding pike
Pikes were kept in a rack on the main deck. In the mêlée of confused fighting that ensued when a ship was boarded they were handy weapons to keep the enemy at a distance.

Brass butt cap, known as a "skull-crusher", used as a club once pistol had been fired

Flint clamp

Pan

Striking steel

30cm (12in) smoothbore barrel

Flintlock mechanism

Brass-tipped ramrod

Feather spring

Pair of Sea Service pistols
Pistols were issued to sailors for boarding. They would normally be used just once, either in the initial attack or as a last resort.